The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

1st february 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Faltering (लड़खड़ाना)

Meaning: Losing strength or momentum; failing or hesitating.
Synonyms: Wavering, stumbling, unsteady
Antonyms: Steady, strong, firm
Example: The company's growth has been faltering due to economic uncertainties.

2. Sputtering (थोड़ा-थोड़ा काम करना)

Meaning: Struggling to function or make progress; operating in a way that is inconsistent or irregular.
Synonyms: Fizzling, stuttering, stalling
Antonyms: Flowing, stable, continuous
Example: The engine began sputtering before finally breaking down.

VOCABULARY

3. Insipid (निरस)

Meaning: Lacking flavor, interest, or energy; dull or bland.
Synonyms: Bland, tasteless, dull
Antonyms: Flavorful, exciting, interesting
Example: The soup was insipid, lacking any distinct flavor.

4. Misadventures (दुर्घटनाएँ)

Meaning: Unfortunate or unlucky events, often resulting in hardship.
Synonyms: Mishaps, accidents, misfortunes
Antonyms: Success, fortune, luck
Example: His misadventures during the trip made the journey unforgettable.

VOCABULARY

5. Brisk (तेज़)

Meaning: Energetic, quick, or lively in movement or action.
Synonyms: Quick, active, lively
Antonyms: Slow, sluggish, lazy
Example: She took a brisk walk around the park to start her day.

6. Deregulation (नियमन की समाप्ति)

Meaning: The removal or reduction of government controls or restrictions on business activities.
Synonyms: Liberalization, disbanding, freeing
Antonyms: Regulation, control, restriction
Example: The government is considering deregulation to stimulate market growth.

VOCABULARY

7. Fomenting (भड़काना)

Meaning: To stir up or encourage the development of something, usually something undesirable.
Synonyms: Instigating, inciting, provoking
Antonyms: Quelling, suppressing, calming
Example: The leader was accused of fomenting unrest among the citizens.

8. Infatuated (मोहित)

Meaning: Possessing an intense but short-lived passion or admiration for someone or something.
Synonyms: Obsessed, captivated, enamored
Antonyms: Indifferent, disinterested, unconcerned
Example: She was infatuated with the idea of moving abroad.

VOCABULARY

9. Vigil (सतर्कता)

Meaning: The act of staying awake and alert, especially to observe or prevent something.
Synonyms: Watchfulness, alertness, attention
Antonyms: Negligence, disregard, inattentiveness
Example: The security team kept vigil during the night to ensure safety.

10. Bristling (भरा हुआ)

Meaning: Full of something, often in an intense or aggressive way.
Synonyms: Overflowing, packed, teeming
Antonyms: Empty, lacking, deficient
Example: The battlefield was bristling with armed soldiers.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Pick from
Meaning: To choose something from a group or set.

2. Choose out
Meaning: To select or choose from a larger group.

3. Narrow down
Meaning: To reduce the number of choices until a final decision is made.

4. Go for
Meaning: To choose or opt for something, often enthusiastically.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. On the ball

Meaning - Quick to understand and react to things

2. Face the music

Meaning - To accept unpleasant consequences

3. Ring a bell

Meaning - To sound familiar or to remind you of something

VOCABULARY

4. Blow off steam

Meaning - To do something that helps you to get rid of strong feelings.

5. Cut to the chase

Meaning - Come to the point

Article for Reading

A pragmatic picture: On the Economic Survey 2024-25

Parliament’s Budget session has begun amid a significantly changed backdrop. India’s growth is seen faltering after four years of healthy post-pandemic growth, the stock markets are tumbling, the rupee is losing ground faster than expected, and the major drivers that have been spurring the economy — domestic demand and public sector capex — are sputtering, while private investments remain insipid. For context, the five years from 2019-20 to 2023-24 have seen government capex increase at a compounded annual growth rate of 16%, household investments by 12%, while corporate outlays were up only 6%, despite a steep tax rate cut for them. A slowdown in the well-moving economic levers is, thus, a cause for concern. That the new U.S. administration seems determined to upend global trade and taxation arrangements, is also unsettling. The Economic Survey 2024-25, has warned that, with globalisation in retreat, India must focus on domestic factors to spur growth higher while becoming more competitive vis-à-vis rival markets looking to attract foreign investors.

The Survey's prognosis that real GDP growth may be in the range of 6.3% to 6.8% in 2025-26, from the 6.4% pace estimated for this year, acknowledges that economic momentum may slip further in the face of new headwinds. That the Survey's authors have posited that anything short of a growth pace of around 8% over at least a decade would make it tough to realise India's aspiration to be a developed nation by 2047, is significant, along with their warning that a 'business as usual' approach risks fomenting economic stagnation. While lauding recent reforms, the Survey has cautioned they will not deliver their desired goals without deregulation. The Survey has some refreshing plainspeak in this context, emphasising it is critical for the government to 'get out of the way' of businesses by undoing regulations that are tantamount to micro-management, and bridging the 'trust deficit' between authorities and citizens, as well as within the nation's close-knit communities.

Pushing for a refresh of the ease of doing business drive, it has made an impassioned plea to minimise controls that distort markets and adopt a ‘minimum necessary, maximum feasible’ approach to regulations, while seeking the same accountability from regulators that they stipulate for their constituents. The pitch to empower small firms, enhance economic freedom and ensure a level-playing field, holds weight too. For a government that has been recently infatuated by a spate of 1970s’-style bad ideas such as import curbs, production-linked incentives and questionable taxation misadventures, this is pertinent advice. Whether the government has bothered to listen, without prejudice, the Budget will tell.

Summary

Parliament's Budget session begins against a backdrop of economic concerns, including slowing growth, falling stock markets, a weakening rupee, and stagnating private investment. While public sector capital expenditure and household investments have been strong in recent years, their slowdown raises alarm. The Economic Survey 2024-25 warns that India's growth could slip further, with GDP projected between 6.3% and 6.8% for 2025-26. Achieving sustained 8% growth is essential for India's goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047. The Survey emphasizes the need for deregulation, urging the government to reduce unnecessary controls and improve trust with businesses. It advocates for a market-driven approach, empowering small firms, enhancing economic freedom, and ensuring a level playing field. The Survey also cautions against outdated economic policies, such as import curbs and excessive state intervention. The upcoming Budget will reveal whether the government heeds these warnings.

Tone:

The tone is critical and analytical, highlighting economic challenges while scrutinizing the government's policy choices. It combines urgency with a call for pragmatic, market-friendly reforms.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What does the passage suggest about the Economic Survey's stance on India's economic policies?

a) It fully supports the government's economic strategies without reservations.
b) It warns that economic stagnation is likely unless significant reforms are undertaken.
c) It dismisses global trade concerns and focuses solely on domestic growth.
d) It argues that government intervention in businesses is necessary for sustained growth.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
Which policy approach does the passage criticize as being reminiscent of the 1970s?

a) Encouraging private sector innovation.
b) Strengthening ease of doing business measures.
c) Import restrictions, production-linked incentives, and questionable taxation policies.
d) Promoting small businesses through deregulation.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What does the passage imply about India's goal to become a developed nation by 2047?

a) It will be easily achievable with current economic policies.
b) It is possible only if India maintains a consistent growth rate of around 8% for a decade.
c) The government should prioritize domestic policies and abandon global trade aspirations.
d) India should shift towards a more protectionist economic model.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Unbroken vigil: On the mid-air accident in the U.S.

Aviation safety experts will be poring over one particular snatch of ATC instructions and exchange to unravel one of the worst air accidents in the United States in recent years. “PAT25, do you have the CRJ in sight?... PAT25, pass behind the CRJ.” Seconds later, another pilot in the vicinity asks air traffic control tersely, “Tower, did you see that?” The mid-air collision between an American Airlines flight, AA5342, a Bombardier CRJ700 regional jet with 64 passengers, while on finals to runway 33 at Ronald Reagan Washington National Airport, and a U.S. Army Sikorsky UH-60 helicopter and its three-member crew, has been described as a baffling accident in one of “the most controlled portions of airspace in the world”. The airport, which handled 25.5 million passengers in 2023, operates in a complex ecosystem: of commercial aviation, private aviation, military traffic as well as helicopter operations existing side by side, with flight paths that often overlap.

It is also an area in political heartland, is near military bases and is in close proximity to Washington Dulles and Baltimore, the other aviation gateways. With such varied aviation operations — and, as a result, airport-specific procedures, which include manoeuvres for noise abatement — and also stringent safety and security requirements, some experts have focused on the potential for incidents to occur when the 'borders' of these operations converge. There will be questions, for example, about the operations of the 12th Aviation Battalion's Army helicopter, a high-technology machine bristling with very accurate electronic aids. Even though it was on an annual night flight training session, the crash could well be a case of the Swiss cheese model of accident causation. In the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA)'s safety records for Reagan, on air misses, about 10 involve military aircraft in 30 such incidents since 1987.

A Government Accountability Office report (2021) shows that over a three-year period that ended in 2019, there were 88,000 helicopter operations within 48 kilometres of Reagan, and these included about 33,000 military and 18,000 law enforcement flights. There has also been some concern, from political quarters in particular, about a series of air incidents flowing from 'understaffed' air traffic control operations across the U.S. With the FAA's International Aviation Safety Assessment (IASA) Program overseeing India as well, the crash investigation findings by the FAA and the National Transportation Safety Board will be most relevant — there are some airports in India that share civil and military traffic — as the Reagan accident is a reminder that air safety demands unbroken vigil.

Question 4
What broader concern does the passage imply about air traffic control in the U.S.?

a) There has been a significant increase in mid-air collisions in recent years.
b) Air traffic controllers lack sufficient training to handle military and commercial aircraft simultaneously.
c) Understaffing in air traffic control could lead to more accidents if not addressed.
d) The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) is overly focused on international regulations at the expense of domestic safety.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Why is the Reagan accident investigation relevant to India, according to the passage?

a) India has airports that also accommodate both civilian and military traffic, making similar risks possible.
b) India has experienced a similar air collision recently.
c) The FAA's International Aviation Safety Assessment (IASA) oversees Indian air traffic control operations.
d) India follows the exact same air traffic control procedures as the U.S.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question

Original Text:

The privatization of banks is a widely debated topic, with arguments both in favor and against it. Privatization involves transferring ownership and control of public sector banks (PSBs) to private entities, aiming to enhance efficiency, competitiveness, and financial stability. Proponents argue that privatization leads to better management, improved customer service, and reduced political interference, while opponents highlight concerns about financial inclusion, stability, and job security. One of the strongest arguments for privatizing banks is efficiency. Private banks generally perform better in terms of profitability, customer service, and risk management compared to PSBs, which often suffer from bureaucratic delays and political pressures.

Privatization can lead to better governance, innovation, and accountability, making the banking sector more competitive and efficient. Additionally, it can reduce the burden on taxpayers, as the government frequently injects funds into struggling PSBs to cover bad loans and inefficiencies. However, privatization also has potential downsides. Public sector banks play a crucial role in financial inclusion by providing banking services to rural and underprivileged populations. Private banks, driven by profit motives, may not prioritize these sectors, potentially widening economic inequality. Additionally, in times of financial crises, government-owned banks act as stabilizers, preventing economic shocks from escalating. Privatization might lead to job losses, as private entities often prioritize cost-cutting measures, affecting thousands of employees in the banking sector.

Precis:

The privatization of banks is debated for its potential to improve efficiency, governance, and competitiveness while reducing government burdens. Private banks often perform better in profitability and innovation, but privatization raises concerns about financial inclusion, job security, and economic stability.

Public sector banks play a vital role in serving rural and underprivileged communities, while government ownership provides stability in crises. A balanced approach—enhancing governance in public banks while allowing private sector participation—can ensure both efficiency and inclusivity in the banking sector.

- **Write a follow-up email to the HR department, thanking them for the interview and politely inquiring about the status of your application.**

To: ……@gmail.com

Subject: Follow-Up on Interview Status – [Your Name]

Dear [HR Representative's Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I wanted to take a moment to sincerely thank you for the opportunity to interview for the [Job Title] position at [Company Name]. I truly appreciate the time you and the team took to speak with me and provide insights into the role and company culture.

I remain very excited about the possibility of joining [Company Name] and contributing to [mention a specific aspect of the role or company that excites you]. I wanted to follow up to inquire if there are any updates regarding my application status.

Please let me know if there is any additional information I can provide to assist in the decision-making process.

I appreciate your time and consideration and look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Email]
[Your Phone Number]

Match the column

1. On the ball
2. Face the music
3. Ring a bell
4. Blow off steam
5. Cut to the chase

A. To do something that helps you to get rid of strong feelings.
B. Come to the point
C. Quick to understand and react to things
D. To accept unpleasant consequences
E. To sound familiar

Answer:

1-c

2-d

3-e

4-a

5-b

Vocabulary

1. Faltering:
2. Sputtering:
3. Insipid:
4. Misadventures:
5. Brisk:
6. Deregulation:
7. Fomenting
8. Infatuated:
9. Vigil:
10. Bristling:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference: "The Survey has cautioned they will not deliver their desired goals without deregulation."

The passage states that the Economic Survey cautions against a 'business as usual' approach, which could lead to stagnation. It calls for deregulation, economic freedom, and a refresh of the ease of doing business framework.

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage indicates criticism of overregulation, implying the Survey does not fully support current policies.

c) The passage notes that globalisation is retreating, but the Survey does not dismiss global trade concerns entirely.

d) The passage explicitly states that the government should "get out of the way" of businesses, contradicting this option.

2.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference: "For a government that has been recently infatuated by a spate of 1970s'-style bad ideas such as import curbs, production-linked incentives and questionable taxation misadventures, this is pertinent advice."

The passage explicitly criticizes the government's inclination towards import curbs, production-linked incentives, and questionable taxation as reminiscent of the 1970s, implying these are outdated economic strategies.

Incorrect Options:

a, b, d These options align with the proposed solutions, not the criticized approaches.

3.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference: "The Survey’s authors have posited that anything short of a growth pace of around 8% over at least a decade would make it tough to realise India’s aspiration to be a developed nation by 2047.”

The passage highlights that the Economic Survey warns India must sustain a growth rate of approximately 8% over a decade to achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage suggests that current policies alone will not be sufficient.

c) While the passage calls for domestic focus, it does not advocate abandoning global trade.

d) The passage criticizes protectionist policies like import curbs.

4.
Ans: c
Explanation:
Reference: "There has also been some concern, from political quarters in particular, about a series of air incidents flowing from ‘understaffed’ air traffic control operations across the U.S.”

The passage mentions concerns from political quarters about ‘understaffed’ air traffic control operations across the U.S., suggesting that this issue could contribute to accidents if not properly managed.

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage does not state an increase in mid-air collisions.
b) There is no suggestion that air traffic controllers lack training.
d) The passage does not criticize the FAA’s focus on international regulations.

5.
Ans: a
Explanation:
Reference: "There are some airports in India that share civil and military traffic — as the Reagan accident is a reminder that air safety demands unbroken vigil."

The passage explicitly states that some Indian airports share airspace between civilian and military operations, implying that lessons from the Reagan accident could be applicable to improving air safety in India.

Incorrect Options:

b) The passage does not mention a recent similar collision in India.
c) While the FAA oversees aviation safety globally, the passage does not suggest direct FAA oversight of India's air traffic control.
d) The passage does not claim that India and the U.S. have identical air traffic control procedures.

NIMISHA BANSAL

EXCLUSIVE SUBSCRIPTION

- ACCESS TO ALL COURSES (PERFECTION, GRAMMAR GRANTH, ERRORS
- Live+ Recorded Sessions
- Class PDF's
- Basic To Advance level
- Best Courses Till Date

Price : ~~₹ 2499~~
₹

USE CODE _____

yes OFFICER

PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION

ALL EDUCATOR COURSES

ALL BANK EXAM 2024 PRELIMS+MAINS

ENGLISH

QUANT

REASONING

GENERAL AWARENESS

FOUNDATION + HIGH LEVEL COURSES

USE CODE

JOIN TELEGRAM CHANNEL

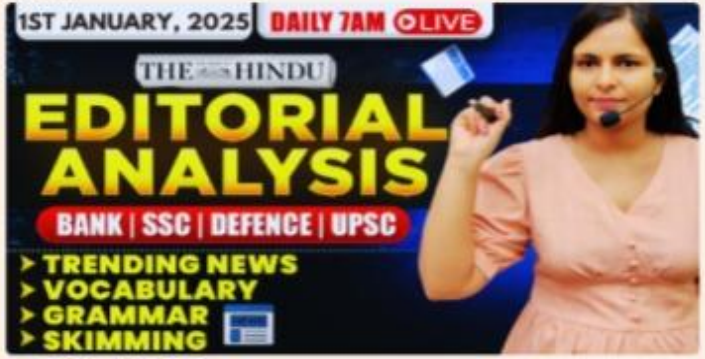
ENGLISH WITH NIMISHA BANSAL

@NimishaMam

English with Nimisha Bansal
452 824 subscribers

YouTube
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal

✅One Premium Subscription
USE CODE - SAFALTA
https...



30K 08:00

Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

CONTENT - NIMISHA BANSAL

@mamnimisha

Content- Nimisha Bansal
174 346 subscribers

annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.6K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
Perfection_Clas...t_Jan_2025.pdf
3.1 MB
Perfection Class Error detection with annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.9K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
PERFECTION CLA...T January.pdf
34.1 MB
PERFECTION CLASS NOTES 1K 14:14

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
EDITORIAL VOC...UARY 2025.pdf
2.7 MB
EDITORIAL VOCAB 1ST JANUARY 2025 1K 14:14